POU11011 — Discussion points and tutorials

10% of the module mark · Michaelmas Term 2026

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Summary

Weight	10% of the module mark
What you submit	Two or three numbered discussion points, 200–400 words in total
How often	Before each of the four tutorials
Deadline	5pm the evening before your tutorial meets
Where	Blackboard
Marking	Pass/fail. Two points for each tutorial you attend with an accepted submission, to a maximum of eight
Attendance	Required. Points without attendance, or attendance without points, earn nothing for that tutorial

What to write

Make some points for discussion that are worth going over in your tutorial. It does not need to be polished, but it should be clearly written, spellchecked, and free of errors that inhibit understanding.

Points that work:

- What the argument requires in order for it to be true
- A case it fits badly (name the case)
- Something in the news that the reading explains, or fails to explain
- Whether you believe it, and what an alternative explanation might be
- Two readings that disagree, and why
- Something you really didn't understand in the readings or lecture

Points that don't: a summary of the reading, "this was interesting", or anything you could have written without opening the text.

Rules

- Late submissions are not accepted, and nothing is accepted after your tutorial has met.
- A submission that is too short or makes no genuine attempt at the reading will not be counted.
- Every submission needs the **Assignment Submission Form** as its first page, as for the blog post and the final essay. A submission without one is not accepted.

Tutorials

The department allocates you to a tutorial group. Your four tutorial dates, times and rooms are in your my.tcd.ie timetable and on Blackboard, and you can only attend the tutorial on your timetable.

If you must miss a tutorial for a valid reason (medical, for example), email your TA at least 24 hours before. How to get credit for an excused tutorial is in the module outline.

Generative AI

Category	This component
Brainstorming	**Not permitted.** The point is that *you* had a reaction to the reading.
Research/learning assistance	**Permitted, for one thing only:** clarifying a term or passage you could not follow after genuinely trying. Not for summarising the reading.
Writing assistance	**Not permitted.** Style is not marked here; spellcheck is fine.
Direct AI content inclusion	**Not permitted.**